

CHAPTER FIRST



The Beginning & The Dream : The Destiny

A low rumble echoed in the distance, growing steadily into a cacophony. Dark, roiling cloud choked the sky, momentarily blotting out the moon with the churning mass. A brilliant flash illuminated the scene—a jagged bolt of lightning splitting followed by a deafening the heavens crack that seemed to shake the very Earth. Rain lashed down in a relentless torrent, each drop a tiny drumbeat against the corrugated metal roof. A flash of lightning a jagged white scar across the inky black sky momentarily illuminated the scene. Below, desolate railway tracks snaked towards a colossal, Gothic train station. The rumble of thunder didn't seem like an ordinary sound; it was a primal roar that shook the very Earth. The rhythmic clanging of metal on metal, punctuated by the occasional mournful cry of locomotive, was the only sound that dared to pierce the stramic Breeze. Then, a deafening roar announced the approach of the train as it hurtled into view, a monstrous serpent of steel carving its path through the storm. Between this monstrous storm, I am too struggles to make my way to the station, it's the

Grand Central Railways, now lost in the tempest's wrath its grandeur marred by the fury of the storm.

Wind howled like a banshee, whipping the flagpoles into frenzy. The imposing structure, once a symbol of human ambition and progress, now resembles a lone sentinel hunched against an onslaught, a lone sentinel against the tempest.

After that night,
the world changed quietly.

So quietly, that most people never noticed it. Almost every one who witnessed the incident died. Some killed. Some simply vanished.

And because no truth remained alive long enough to be spoken, the world buried the event beneath a safer name:

"The Tragedy of the Grand Central Railways"

But_____,

That night was never a tragedy alone.

A cursed Seed has been sown.

With the curse of the cursed one

"The Curse Seed of the Phantoms"

*(The oldest rebellions began to move again. The rituals has
started.).....*

This is the story of one of the two eternal treasures of the cosmos. Love.

A man who once became a victim of the conservative mindset of this world.

The same world he had risked everything to protect, his life too

That same world crucified his love on the cross of its narrow thinking.

The shock broke him, not from his love, but from this society.

He realized now, the mentality of this world can never be changed.

So, he took a step.

A step that went against the structure of this very Creation.

It was a path too dark for any living being.

To make it his own, he first sacrificed himself. But using the knowledge of *Death Yoni*, which he had developed, he remained alive though no longer a normal being.

He became a living shadow rising from his own grave,
without much emotions and memories.

But still carrying the awareness of his immense power and the presence of his eternal, beautiful love.

He began raising his old companions from their graves too.

He also gathered those still alive. And together, he created a new specis. Not ghosts, but shadows of those once living.

Souls who now only remember what their master allows.

This Creation called them: *The Phantoms*.

They live among us. Among their families.

But they are not the same anymore.

After this came a Great Revolution,
Which led to the *Great War of Kutumb*.

Many consequences arose from it,
But this creation buried them all,
Except three.

Three consequences remain.

The entire stream of past time has been drawn out into this creation. However,
from the three remaining streams, new currents have now begun to emerge.

And working through one of them, we will reach the end of this story.

THE ERA OF UNIVERSAL CONFLICTS.

So let us continue the journey...

Now I ride throug the cold Breeze, blew through the strom, carring sheets
of rain and flashes of lightning into the dark sky. From the station top, the
wind rushed across the cobblestone streets, passing through narrow
alleys and wide streets by taking many turns like the breze itself wanted
to reach somewhere.

The city felt abandoned.

Not asleep.

Abandoned.
Then—

The wind stopped before a small house at the end of the street. Its windows trembled softly. The sign above the door creaked against the storm.

A flash of lightning.

The wind slipped through a half-open window. Inside, the room was dark. Quiet. Almost lifeless. A crooked calendar hung on the wall. Thunder exploded across the sky. For a second, the entire room turned white.

Then darkness again.
Another flash.
The calendar appeared once more.

And this time—

The date seemed to shine through the storm itself.

April 17th, 2027.

Like the night
had been waiting for it.

Suddenly, the view swung up towards the ceiling, revealing a figure lying motionless on a bed. A flicker of lightning cut through the darkness, momentarily illuminating the room in a spectral glow. The view zoomed on an alarm clock parched on the nightstand. The harsh red digits blinked accusingly 02:52 AM.

May, it will be a awake-up call soon, not just for that sleeping figure, but for the entire city that seemed to hold its breath in anticipation of what the coming day might bring....

The alarm rings.

A hand emerges from the darkness and silences it before the sound can spread any further.

For a few moments, nothing moves. Only the rain continues its endless conversation with the windows. Cold wind drifts through the room,

carrying the scent of wet earth and distant thunder. The curtains sway gently in the darkness, like restless spirits wandering without a destination. Every few seconds, lightning briefly illuminates the room, only to surrender it back to the shadows.

A man stands near the window. Watching the storm. Watching the rain race down the glass. Watching a night that feels strangely familiar.

"You still haven't slept?"

The voice comes softly from the bed. He does not turn immediately. A faint smile appears on his face.

Small. Tired.

Almost nostalgic.

"Actually," he says quietly, "I did sleep."

Lightning flashes across the room. For a moment, his blue eyes reflect the pale light. Then his expression changes.

"But..."

His voice grows distant.

"I woke up somewhere else."

The woman slowly sits up. The blanket slips from her shoulder as she watches him through the darkness. Something in his voice unsettles her more than the storm outside.

"What do you mean?"

He remains silent for a moment. His gaze stays fixed on the rain. Then he asks softly, "Did you feel it too?"

Outside, thunder rolls across the sky like a giant awakening from an ancient sleep. And suddenly, he sees it again.

The endless white mist, the silent forest, the pond, the calm water.

That place never feels like a dream.

Dreams fade. That place never does. His breathing slows.

"We're running out of time."

The room becomes still.

Not silent. Still.

The kind of stillness that arrives before something changes forever.

The woman studies him carefully. Her fingers tighten around the deep green pendant resting against her chest. As though somewhere deep inside, she already knows what he is about to say.

"No..."

Another flash of lightning fills the room.

For a brief moment, her beautiful green eyes shimmer beneath the pale light. Tears begin gathering there.

Slowly.

Silently.

They slide down her soft cheeks, leaving silver trails behind before falling toward her collarbone. The deep green pendant reflects their shine softly, casting a gentle glow against her beautiful face.

She swallows. Then asks in a soft and carrying voice,
"What happened? Aryan"

Aryan finally turns toward her. And for a moment...

everything inside him falls silent.

The storm. The fear.

The dream. The future.

None of it matters.

All he sees is her.

The woman he loves. The woman carrying their child.

The woman he would choose again in every lifetime.

He closes his eyes briefly.

Then whispers,

"I think they've found us."

Thunder explodes outside. The room trembles.

Neither of them speaks.

It feels as though the night itself has entered the room and is listening. Slowly, she rises from the bed. One hand instinctively rests beneath the weight of her swollen stomach. The other presses against the wall for support.

Pain flickers across her face. But she keeps walking.
Barefoot. Slowly. Carefully.

Not carrying only her own fear. Carrying another life within her. And even now...
she chooses to stand beside him. She reaches for his hand. Her fingers slip between his. Warm.
Familiar.
Home.

"Do you really think something bad is going to happen to us?"

Aryan looks at her. Truly looks at her. As if he is trying to memorize every detail.
The curve of her smile. The tears in her eyes.
The way she always finds the strength to comfort him when she herself is afraid.

He gently places his hand against her cheek.

"No."

His voice is quiet. Yet strong enough to carry all the strength she needs.

"Nothing can happen to us."

For a moment, she almost believes him.
Then suddenly—

Pain tears through her body. A sharp gasp escapes her lips. Her knees buckle. Aryan catches her before she can fall. Panic immediately floods his face.

"No..." His grip tightens.

"No, no, no..." Fear begins creeping into his voice.

"Please..."

Another wave of pain crashes through her. She clutches his shirt tightly. Her fingers tremble.
Aryan carefully helps her back toward the bed.

"It's okay." His voice shakes.
"It's okay." He kneels beside her.

"Breathe."
Another cry escapes her lips. Tears stream freely down her cheeks now.
Aryan quickly grabs his phone and dials for help.

No signal.
He tries again.
Nothing.

The storm has swallowed the world beyond these walls. For the first time that night, genuine fear settles into his heart. Not fear for himself.

Fear for her. Fear for the child. Fear of losing the future he has not yet held in his arms. Running a trembling hand through his hair, he looks toward the raging storm outside. And for the first time since waking from the dream...
he wonders if the sage's warning has already begun.

Then suddenly,
She reached for his wrist.

"Listen to me..."

Her breathing shook between every word.

"Whatever happens tonight..."
Another painful breath escaped her.

"Nothing can happen to our child."

His eyes immediately filled.
Not with panic.

He knelt beside her and gently pushed the wet hair away from her face.

"Nothing will happen," he whispered.

She looked at him quietly for several seconds.
Then, despite the pain,

She smiled.
Weakly.
Lovingly.

The kind of smile that exists only between two people who have already
survived too much together.

"You're lying."

He laughed softly. A broken laugh.
"Yeah."

Another silence settled between them. But this one felt different.
Softer.
Sad enough to be beautiful.

Outside, the storm kept raging like the end of the world.
Inside, he rested his forehead gently against hers.

And suddenly.....

None of it felt important for one small moment. Not the fear.
Not the shadows hunting them.
Not even death.

Only this.
Only her.

"I'm scared," she admitted quietly.

His eyes closed.
"So am I."

A tear escaped her eye.
"You know what scares me the most?"

He looked at her carefully.
She smiled again.

"That tonight feels important."

The words shattered something inside him. Because he understood exactly what she meant. Like the universe itself was standing outside the door, waiting patiently for them to finish saying goodbye.

He pulled her closer slowly, carefully protecting her from the pain in her body.

"You remember our first train ride together?" he asked softly.

A small laugh escaped her lips through the tears.
"You spilled coffee on yourself."

He replied, "Yes and You laughed at me for ten minutes."
She said, " Because You looked cute."

He smiled. "No," he whispered.
"I looked nervous."

She said, "Yes, You were nervous."

Aryan immediately, "Because I already loved you."

Her eyes widened slightly.

Even after all these years, those words still reached her differently. The storm outside dimmed for a moment beneath the sound of their breathing.

Then finally, she whispered softly,
"I love you."

She paused.
"No..."

Her tearful eyes met his.

"I think I simply recognize myself in you."

She continues,

"Aryan, I love you."

"Perhaps because, no matter how many times I look at you.....

It never feels like I am looking at someone else."

For a moment, Aryan could not speak.

His throat tightened.

Not because he was afraid. But because some emotions become too large for words.

A tear escaped his eye as he looked at her.

Really looked at her. Then, with a trembling smile, he whispered,

"I love you too. Nikita."

He gently pressed his forehead against hers.

"And I think that's why I have never been afraid of death. Because if one day my heart stops beating..."

His fingers slowly tightened around hers.

"...I know my love for you won't."

A tear rolled down his cheek.

"People say two souls meet and fall in love. I don't think that's what happened to us." For a moment, his eyes searched hers. Then he smiled through his tears.

"We were never two souls to begin with."

He closed his eyes.

"And perhaps that is why losing you has always felt impossible."

"How can a soul lose what it was never separate from?"

The tears in her eyes overflowed, not from sadness, but from the unbearable beauty of being understood so completely. It felt as though every fear she had ever carried, every lonely corner of her heart, had finally found its way home.

A trembling smile touched her lips.

And in that moment, with the storm raging outside and his forehead resting against hers, she realized something strange.

She could no longer tell whether the warmth she felt belonged to her heart or his.

Perhaps love, at its deepest, was simply the moment when that distinction no longer mattered.

And after the silence of few minutes she finally whispered,
"Where do we go now...?"

He looked toward the photograph hanging beside the wall. The two of
them smiling beneath sunlight.

A memory from another lifetime.

Another world.

He stared at it quietly. Then finally turned back toward her.

And somewhere between fear and love he found enough strength to
answer.

"Aryan." She looked at him softly.

"Hm ? That's my name."

A faint smile appeared on her lips despite everything.

"I know."

He held her hand tighter.

Then finally whispered,

"We're going to Grand Central Railways."

**What you call love,
is just the moment you stopped running from yourself.
You did not find her in this world.
You found every unanswered question of your life, only
within you.
And realized, with trembling hands,
that the home you spent a lifetime searching for
was never a place.
It's within you.
She is always within you.
Know yourself, find yourself,
then only you can find Her.**

Sometimes, in the quietest corners of sleep, we glimpse lives that do not belong to us. Or perhaps they do.
Perhaps the soul remembers things that the mind was never meant to know.

Rain.

That was the first thing he heard.

Not saw.
Heard.

An endless downpour falling somewhere far away. Or perhaps very close.
The sound swallowed everything else.
Then came flashes.

A red clock.
4:00 AM.
A trembling hand holding another. A green pendant glimmering beneath a flash of lightning. An auto rickshaw cutting through empty streets.
Then darkness.

The glimpse shifted like a dream.
Now the storm seemed larger now.
Almost alive.

Streetlights stretched across rain soaked roads like fading stars. Water raced through the streets, carrying reflections that broke apart before they could form. Inside the auto, a man sat beside a pregnant woman, his arm wrapped protectively around her shoulders.
The woman leaned against him.

Exhausted. Frightened. Yet strangely peaceful.

For a brief moment, their eyes met. The kind of glance shared by two people who no longer needed words to understand each other.
Then the glimpse shattered again.

A train whistle. A platform. Wet footsteps.

A distant announcement swallowed by thunder.

The number 04:23 glowing somewhere above the crowd.
Faces blurred together.

Voices came and went like echoes underwater.
Only one remained clear.
"What if they find us?"
The woman. Fear trembled within her voice.

Then another glimps, flash shift.

A hand tightening around hers. "We'll be okay." The words felt less like certainty and more like prayer.
The train arrived. Its headlights pierced the darkness.
Then everything accelerated.

Doors opening.
People moving.
Rain striking the platform.
A suitcase.
A green pendant.
A smile.
A trembling hand resting over a swollen stomach.

Fragments.
Only fragments.

As though the glimpse itself was struggling to remember.
The glimpse, they are not just some random glimpse in this SAGA, in this JOURNEY, It's a dream. But if it's a dream so, whose dream?

Then suddenly...
The pace slowed.
The train.
A narrow compartment.

Rain streaming down the windows.
The storm outside had become a living thing now. Every strike of thunder shook the carriage. Every gust of wind seemed capable of tearing the train from the tracks.

A pregnant women beside her husband.

Her head rested against his shoulder. His fingers remained intertwined with hers.

For a moment, neither moved.
Neither spoke. Only the sound of wheels rolling endlessly through the darkness accompanied them.

Then pain crossed her face.
Small at first.
Barely noticeable.
A slight tightening of her jaw.
A sharp breath.
Another.

He noticed immediately, his entire body became alert. Fear entered his eyes. Not fear for himself. Fear for her. She lowered her head and pressed a hand against her stomach. Her breathing grew uneven. The train continued moving, the storm continued raging. And somewhere between those two things, the moment they had been waiting for finally arrived.

"Ar...n..."
Her voice barely escaped her lips.
"The baby..."

The glimpse fractured once more.
A door opening.
Passengers standing.
A young woman rushing forward.
A medical bag.
Running footsteps.
Voices.
Lights.
Darkness.
The world became a blur of motion.
Then it slowed again.

Far slower this time.

As though even the dream understood the importance of what came next.

A small medical ward.
Dim lights swaying overhead.
Rain tapping softly against the windows.

That pregnant lady lay upon a narrow bed.
Tears slipped silently from her eyes.
Not tears of fear.
Not tears of weakness.
The tears of someone standing at the edge of one life while bringing
another into existence.

Her husband sat beside her. His hand never left hers. Not even for a
moment. He spoke occasionally. Words the dream could no longer
remember.

But somehow their meaning remained.
I am here. I am not leaving. You are not alone.

Outside, thunder shook the heavens.
Inside, another battle was being fought.
One far greater.

Minutes passed.
Or perhaps hours.
Dreams never cared about time.

Pain rose and fell like waves against a shore.
Again. And again. And again.
Yet she endured.
Because there are moments when love becomes stronger than
suffering. And this was one of them.

Then finally...
Now the Dream slowed again.

But this time, slower to the perfection. It now feels like real time.

Doctor urgently : "The baby's almost here. Ni...i.a, takes a deep breath, I
need you to push !"
She, exhausted and terrified, pushes with all her remaining strength.

Now, Her husband is outside the ward, tears in his eyes, he tried to feel her pain as well, or the moment they've both been waiting for finally arrives.

But just as the baby is about to be born,..... She can't handle the pain much, now. She is moaning in a very painful situation, He is feeling her pain through her screams just by hearing it from outside But.....

Then, suddenly everything became quiet and then, the moment everyone was Waiting, arrived. A..ya..'s ears are filled with the sound of the cry of the new born.

He knocks on the door, and the doctor goes to open

it.....

In this universe, life and death are not opposites.

They are the same breath —

One inhaled,

One exhaled.

**The cry that announces arrival
and the silence that announces departure
are written in the same hand.**

BHOOOOOOMMMMMmmm!!!!!! Powerful. Deep Explosion.
A jagged, trident thunder strikes the train, a deafening explosion rips through the train. The impact is sudden and catastrophic - the train derailed- Crashed- , and the metal frame grans as it begins to collapse violently, from the top of the bridge.
That Man, who just became a father, screaming in panic:
"NAAAAAOOOOOOOOOoooooooooo!!"
"Niii--iiiiaaaa---aaaaa"
Then, another powerfull thunder strikes
BHHOOOOOOOOOOOOMMMMMMMMMmmmmmm!!!!!!!.....

And now, with this strike, everything was obliterated. If anything remains it were just the broken bodies of those who, just moments before, had been alive enjoining their journey with their family, friends, relatives and with their children and their grandparents aslo. Now the scene left nothing but a haunting of life suddenly turned into lifelessness. Only silence.
The silence that announces departure.

The Dream shifts in an instant, a rapid series of fragmented, haunting glimpses:

The train, now a twisted Wreckage lies in flames at the bottom of a bridge along the river bank.

His burned hand, reaching out in the darkness, searching for his wife.

The doctor, her face frozen in shock, holding the lifeless body of a small, burned new born.

Her last breath, her hand slipping form her husband's burnrd body, as the light fades from her eyes.

The image dissolus into darkness and the sound of the strom..... fades.

Then suddenly, BHOOOOOOMMmmmmmm.....!!!!!!!

Again,
The alarm rings

It is 04:00 AM, piercing through the silence of a small, dimly lit bedroom. A young boy, drenched in sweat, bolts upright in bed, his chest heaving as he gasps for breath. His heart pounds in his chest and his light Blue eyes are wide with panic, still gripped by the terror of the nightmare that tore him from his sleep.

He gets up, his body trembling, and walks to the window. As he pulls back the curtain, he sees that the storm has passed. The sky is clear, with the faint light of dawn beginning to break on the horizon. The boy stands there, staring out at the calm morning, his mind racing as he tries to shake the lingering images from his dream. The train, the explosion, the blooded faces of the man and the woman, the doctor holding a burned new born—all of them feel so real, as if they were more than just a dream.

The room is silent, except for the faint sound of the wind outside. Suddenly, there's a creak at the door behind him. He doesn't turn, but his eyes flicker slightly, acknowledging the presence he feels. A soft voice breaks the silence.
"So you haven't slept yet?"

He doesn't respond immediately, still staring out the window, his mind replaying the dream he just had. After a moment, he sighs deeply, his voice barely above a whisper.
"I did sleep. But I..." He paused and continues. "I wake up somewhere else."

**The dream does not visit you.
You build it.
Every shadow you run from wears your own face.
Waking does not end the dream,
it only changes the name of the dreamer.
One has a name, the other does not.
You were never asleep. You were never awake. You simply were.**

END PART: I